

Everyday *Loaf*

from the kitchen of Yahya

1 STANDARD LOAF • RISE 2 HRS • BAKE 30–35 MIN • 375°F (190°C)

The dough that does everything. Built on a baker's formula at 64% hydration — soft enough for sandwiches, sturdy enough to shape free-form. The percentages are by weight of flour, so scale it up or down and it stays true.

a photo of the loaf goes here ♦

deep golden, cooled on a rack

FORMULA • 1 LOAF

Flour (AP or bread)	375 g • 100%	Sugar (or Honey)	12 g • 3.2%
Water (warm)	240 g • 64%	Salt	9 g • 2.4%
Butter or Oil	14 g • 3.7%	Active Dry Yeast	7 g • 1.9%
Total Dough		657 g • 175.2%	

Hydration = water ÷ flour × 100 = 64%. Aim for a final dough temp of 76–78°F (24–26°C) — adjust water temp to hit it.

METHOD

- 1 **Bloom the yeast.** Stir the yeast (7 g) and sugar (12 g) into the warm water (240 g). Rest 5–10 min until foamy.
- 2 **Mix.** Combine flour (375 g) and salt (9 g). Add the yeast water and butter or oil (14 g). Mix to a rough, shaggy dough.
- 3 **Knead.** 10 min by hand (or 6–7 min in a stand mixer on medium) until smooth and elastic — it should pass a windowpane test.
- 4 **Bulk rise.** Cover and ferment ~1 hr at warm room temperature, until doubled.
- 5 **Shape.** Gently degas, shape into a tight loaf, seam-side down in a greased 9×5 in pan (or free-form on a tray).
- 6 **Proof.** Cover and proof 45–60 min, until the dough crowns ~1 in above the rim and springs back slowly when poked.
- 7 **Bake.** 375°F (190°C) for 30–35 min, until deep golden and the internal temperature reads 200–205°F (93–96°C).
- 8 **Cool.** Turn out and cool on a rack at least 1 hr before slicing — cutting hot bread gums the crumb.

Yahya's note: the loaf is done when the thermometer says so, not when the timer rings. 64% hydration is forgiving — wetter for a more open crumb, drier for tidy sandwich slices, but weigh it either way.